NEVER FIGHT OR ARGUE AGAIN

The Stop-Loss Strategy

Protect the conversation before it becomes destructive.

WHERE THE CONVERSATION IS HEADING



YOUR STOP-LOSS — THE LINE YOU AGREED ON

You never go from calm to conflict in one step. You go from pinch, to emotion, to reaction. The stop-loss exists to interrupt that chain — while you still have something worth protecting.

> *"Above all else, guard your heart...."* — PROVERBS 4:23

CALL IT THE MOMENT ANY ONE OF THESE APPEARS

Emotional escalation
Raised voices. Sarcasm or harsh tone. Interrupting. Reacting instead of listening.

Loss of control
You feel flooded. You are no longer thinking clearly. You are rehearsing your defense.

Disrespect
Name-calling. Dragging up the past. Blame-shifting. Eye-rolling or shutting down.

Process breakdown
SCIP is gone. No listening or validating. The same point, repeated, going nowhere.

HOW TO CALL IT & WHAT TO DO NEXT

99

"I'm feeling overwhelmed — I need to call a stop-loss."

"I want to do this right, but I need a reset."

"I care about this too much to keep going like this."

Pre-agreed. Honored immediately. No arguing about it, no chasing, no continuing the discussion.

1. **Pause** — Stop talking immediately. No last word.
2. **Separate** — Different rooms or space. Reduce the stimulation.
3. **Regulate** — Sit down. Calm down. Identify what you feel. Process it.
4. **Do not rehearse** — No comebacks. No building your case. Calm and clarity, not winning.

HOW LONG TO STEP AWAY

MINIMUM	RECOMMENDED	MAXIMUM
20–30 MINUTES	30–60 MINUTES	24 HOURS
What your body needs to calm down physiologically.	Enough time for a full emotional reset.	Never leave the issue unresolved beyond a day.

Set the return time before you leave. Come back to the process, not to the conflict — open softly, listen first, and check that you are both ready.

THE STOP-LOSS AGREEMENT — WE AGREE TO

- **Call it** when either of us needs it
- **Honor it** immediately, with no resistance
- **Return** at the time we agreed on
- **Restart** with the process, not the emotion

> Stopping the conversation doesn't mean failure.
> *It means you care enough to do it right."*

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